Client Coverage Memo — Northwind Logistics Corp.

Meridian Capital Partners Industrials Investment Banking | Prepared by: Coverage Team (S. Alvarez, MD) | Updated: 4 Nov 2026

Relationship Overview

Northwind is a **Tier 1 coverage client** and a lending relationship: the firm holds a $150M commitment in the $1.5B revolving credit facility. The firm was active bookrunner on the 2022 $800M bond and co-manager on the 2017 notes due 2027. 3-year wallet to the firm: $9.6M (wallet share ~15%, #4 among banks).

Key Client Contacts

Name	Title	Relationship notes
Robert Hale	Chairman & CEO	25-year company veteran; defensive about activist campaign
Linda Osei	EVP & Chief Financial Officer	Primary contact; focused on investment-grade rating
Kevin Brandt	Treasurer	Runs refinancing workstream; wants early read on bond demand
Sofia Romano	SVP Strategy & M&A	Owns cold-chain acquisition evaluation

Recent Interactions (Call Reports)

15 Sep 2026 – Treasurer call: Brandt asked for a refinancing options analysis for the June 2027 notes, including a dual-tranche 7yr/10yr structure and a potential make-whole call on the existing notes.

08 Oct 2026 – Strategy session: Romano shared that FrostLine's sponsor is running a sale process with first-round bids due late November. Northwind has signed an NDA. They have not yet appointed a sell-side or buy-side advisor — **this is our key opportunity**.

22 Oct 2026 – CFO dinner: Osei is worried about Kestrel's demand to spin intermodal. She asked for a confidential defense preparedness review. CEO is sensitive on this topic; position it as 'shareholder engagement'.

Open Opportunities

Opportunity	Est. size	Est. fee	Probability	Timing
Buy-side advisory – FrostLine	~$2.1B EV	$12–15M	45%	Q4 2026–Q2 2027
Acquisition financing (bridge + bonds)	$1.0–1.2B	$6–8M	40%	With M&A
2027 notes refinancing	$1.2B	$3–4M	70%	Q1 2027
Activism defense advisory	n/a	$3–5M retainer	35%	Ongoing

Suggested Talking Points for Next Meeting

1) Lead with a combined M&A; + financing package for FrostLine showing pro-forma leverage and rating impact. 2) Show that refinancing the 2027 notes early de-risks the balance sheet ahead of any acquisition. 3) Offer a quiet shareholder-engagement review (do not use the word 'defense' with the CEO). 4) Highlight the firm's cold-chain sector expertise and our existing revolver commitment.